Brian McManus

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School Administrator & ELA Educator | Professional Learning, Teacher Coaching & i-Ready Data

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

School administrator with 20+ years in K–12 education, including 10 years teaching high school English and 6 years as an assistant principal in New Jersey and Dubai. Coached a 26-teacher English department on unit design aligned to the NJ Student Learning Standards for ELA, and designs professional development for audiences of 190+ educators. Facilitates data meetings that turn i-Ready and MAP results into student action plans, and built an i-Ready data dashboard for teachers, leaders and specialists.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Professional Learning:** PD Design & Facilitation, Adult Learning, Instructional Coaching, Observation & Feedback Cycles, Professional Learning Communities
- **ELA Curriculum & Standards:** Common Core State Standards (ELA), NJ Student Learning Standards (ELA), Concept-Based Teaching, Explicit Instruction, Science of Learning, Curriculum & Assessment Alignment
- **Data & Assessment:** i-Ready, MAP Growth, Data Meetings & Action Planning, Formative Assessment
- **Implementation & EdTech:** Program Implementation & Evaluation, Blended & Adaptive Learning, Moodle, H5P, SCORM, Canvas

EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Co-Principal, Operations — ngenAOS, Seaside Heights, NJ Jul 2026 – Present

- Co-founded a website and Answer Engine Optimization (AEO) service for New Jersey shore businesses; after three months building the operating infrastructure, signed 6 clients and launched 4 managed sites
- Runs the client side end to end, from cold calls and presentations to business owners through proposals, contracts, design, onboarding and quality checks, while managing several client projects at once
- Prepares design and content packages for a developer co-founder's automated build process and reviews each site before launch

Team Principal — Lucid North LLC, Toms River, NJ Jul 2025 – Present

- Leads development of Harry Llama, an AI-powered substitute-scheduling platform for K–12 schools, piloting and refining it with New Jersey school leaders
- Conducts discovery calls with district administrators across New Jersey to understand staffing needs and validate the product
- Develops outreach and sales materials matched to the challenges districts describe

Assistant Principal — South Brunswick High School, South Brunswick, NJ Jul 2020 – Jun 2024

- Coached a 26-teacher English department through observation cycles, summative meetings and feedback, lesson planning and unit enhancement grounded in Science of Learning principles
- Strengthened ELA units with concept-based teaching, explicit instruction and assessments aligned to the taught curriculum and the NJ Student Learning Standards for ELA
- Designed and facilitated professional development for 190+ educators using active learning, cognitive load theory and formative assessment, leading to a 31% rise in student engagement and 28% improvement in knowledge retention
- Facilitated structured assessment-data meetings with special education teachers, reading interventionists and other specialists, turning results into action plans for individual students
- Directed a multi-phase curriculum audit and introduced shared rubrics, improving alignment between taught and assessed curriculum by 44%
- Rolled out blended learning tools and adaptive platforms across departments, raising implementation consistency by 34%

Assistant Principal of Academics — Universal American School, Dubai, UAE Jul 2018 – Jun 2020

- Coached English teachers through observation cycles, feedback and lesson planning, strengthening unit design and assessment alignment
- Led cross-department alignment to the Common Core State Standards for grades 6–12, reaching 97% curricular alignment and improving instructional consistency by 34%
- Delivered virtual professional development for 70+ educators using Moodle, H5P, SCORM content and branching-scenario modules, increasing engagement by 26%
- Built a technology adoption framework tied to instructional goals and data privacy, reallocating 22% of the technology budget and cutting procurement time by 33%

International School of Beijing, Beijing, PRC Jun 2008 – Jun 2018

Strategic Learning Coordinator Jul 2015 – Jun 2018

- Built onboarding programs for new hires, using data and feedback to raise new-staff satisfaction from 65% to 92% in three years
- Designed and scaled experiential learning programs across five countries, growing student participation from 18% to 67%

High School English Teacher Jun 2008 – Jul 2015

- Developed and taught a critical thinking curriculum for non-IB high school English courses within the Common Core framework, strengthening students' reading comprehension and analytical writing
- Led teacher professional learning communities focused on assessment practices and instructional innovation

High School English Teacher — Everglades High School, Miramar, FL Jun 2005 – Jul 2008

- Designed student-centered learning experiences that increased engagement and built a growth mindset in learners

PROJECTS

i-Ready Student Performance Data Dashboard — GitHub

- Built a dashboard that turns raw i-Ready CSV exports into district and grade-level overviews for administrators, class and student growth views for teachers, and intervention-group tracking for specialists

EDUCATION

- **M.A.**, Writing & Literature — Deakin University
- **M.Ed.**, International Secondary Education — The College of New Jersey
- **Post-Graduate Certificate**, Educational Leadership — The College of New Jersey
- **B.S.**, Marketing — York College of Pennsylvania

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Council of International Schools — International Evaluation Team Member
- Middle States Commission — Peer Evaluator